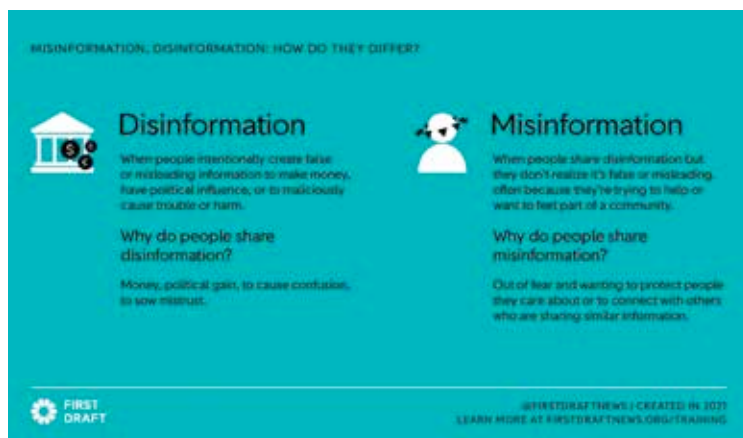


Misinformation vs. Disinformation

Contrary to popular belief, there is a difference between misinformation and disinformation.

The terms misinformation and disinformation are often used interchangeably. Although misinformation and disinformation have certain similarities, they are not the same. Unlike misinformation, which is transmitted without the awareness that it is false, disinformation is spread with full knowledge of its inaccuracy.

Misinformation is exemplified by urban tales. Many individuals believe urban legends are factual, or at the very least have some validity to them.



Credit: First Draft News

Both harmful, yet not the same

The Slender Man phenomenon is an example of a modern urban legend that has spread over the internet. The story of Slender Man, a bogeyman, was passed around by the kids. Two children eventually claimed that Slender Man forced them to attempt murder.

This guide concentrates on misinformation since it is more prevalent and difficult to detect than disinformation. Keep in mind, however, that the fact-checking techniques described here can also be used to combat disinformation.

Spreads like wildfire

People may now communicate with each other more easily than ever before, regardless of time or location, thanks to instant communication and social